

Cover letter — Quantitative Science Studies

29 July 2026

Dear Editors of Quantitative Science Studies,

I submit “Reconstructing Journal Thematic Identity from Article-Level Topics: A Reproducible Framework and a Preregistered Temporal Validation,” an original single-author article not under consideration elsewhere.

Editorial classifications assign each journal to predefined fields, yet what it publishes need not coincide with its label. The manuscript asks how a profile reconstructed from a journal’s articles should be reported so that an inferred description is never mistaken for an intrinsic property, nor treated as a correction of the editorial scheme.

The contribution is not a new indicator but a methodological discipline: a strict separation between a journal’s observed thematic representation and any inferred thematic identity, organized around the observation–inference separation principle: a representation is observed; an identity is inferred.

Because the framework is only as trustworthy as its application, I submit it to a preregistered prospective replication and a documentary control, and report the outcome as the rule returns it. The temporal replication weakens, rather than confirms, the expected stability pattern, and I present that without reinterpretation.

To facilitate independent verification, the submission includes a complete reproducibility package comprising the canonical implementation, preregistrations, data manifests, and a code-to-documentation audit. SHA-256 version identifiers link each reported quantity to the implementation that produced it. A preprint and the reproducibility package are publicly available at Zenodo (<https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21659764>).

I am a consultant at RosFlo Limitada, which supported this work, and am developing an analytics product related to the method. These interests are disclosed in the manuscript. The preregistration, prospectively fixed thresholds, and public reproducibility package were intended to mitigate potential sources of bias.

I believe this work is well suited to Quantitative Science Studies because it addresses the methodological foundations of journal characterization while emphasizing reproducibility and transparent empirical validation.

Thank you for considering this submission.

Sincerely, Francisco Javier Garrido Valdés

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